SWINDON FILM SOCIETY
Annual Report for 2025- 26 Season

Introduction

Last season's films were well received and we had some good attendances. We were pleased to welcome everyone and I would like to thank all members and guests who supported us throughout the season. Once again, we would like to thank the Arts Centre staff and volunteers for their contribution.

We try to provide a varied programme with films from a range of genres and different parts of the world. We always welcome feedback from our members on the films we show. So please feel free to make suggestions and give us your ideas.

You may recall last winter some very cold evenings in the theatre when the Arts Centre heating broke down. Our thanks go to the Arts Centre for allowing us to screen an extra film at cost price in compensation. In May we showed the *Ballad of Wallis Island*, which turned out to be an entertaining and popular addition to our programme.

I would like to take this opportunity to acknowledge the committee's hard work over the year. Especially I would like to highlight Sue Pycroft's sterling efforts in securing sponsorship for our 2026/7 season from Deacons the Jewellers, who have paid for all our printed material and from Haines Watts who have funded an article on Swindon Film in the Link Magazine.

Other good news over the summer was that we were successful in obtaining an award from the *Cinema for All* equipment fund. We have used this money to purchase a laptop which we are using this season to screen films via digital download. Digital downloading has become a necessity since many of the films we want to show are no longer available in disc format.

Finally, Swindon Film has received funding from the British Film Institute (BFI) via Create Studios in Swindon towards the cost of film licences in the current season. We are very grateful for this contribution.

Finance

These notes should be read in conjunction with the annual financial accounts which have been audited.

OUTLINE: In the year ending 31st July 2026, Swindon Film made a loss of £718. This loss is considerably larger than the previous year's and unsustainable in the long-run. The Income & Expenditure Statement (on page 5 of the accounts) presents the figures from the year 2019-20 to enable annual comparisons.

INCOME: The total income for the period was £9,165, which is £67 less that the income in the previous year. Compared with 2024-25, we received £208 less in membership fees and £79 less in ticket sales. We received a slightly lower rate of interest on our investment account and are grateful for the donations received in 2025-26.

SPENDING: Our expenditure of £9,884 was £650 more than the previous year; this was a significant increase. The two biggest costs continue to be the hire of the Arts Centre and paying the film licences. The cost of hiring the theatre has remained constant but, despite careful research by Committee members, the licence fees have increased by £93. There was also a rise of £240 in printing costs as more leaflets were printed in a drive to attract new audiences. Other expenditure has remained fairly constant.

We are grateful to Ian Robertson, retired accountant, who has once again been kind enough to examine our books and sign them off free of charge, also to Richard Turpin for the Website maintenance and Rachel Martin for her artwork and design services.

SUMMARY: Reduced income from membership fees and admissions together with increased licence fees and printing costs were key factors leading to an overall loss in 2025-26. Whilst we still have assets amounting to £10,542, a loss of £718 is obviously not sustainable. We try to keep admission costs at a reasonably competitive level but the Committee agreed that we had to increase the Full season membership by £5 to £85 (making it £6.07 per film) and the Pay as you Go tickets by £1 to £9 and £8 (for concessions) for 2026-27.

We continue to promote Swindon Film and have had encouraging success with sponsorship from local businesses and some grants. It is hoped that this support will lead to a more comfortable financial position by the end of next season.

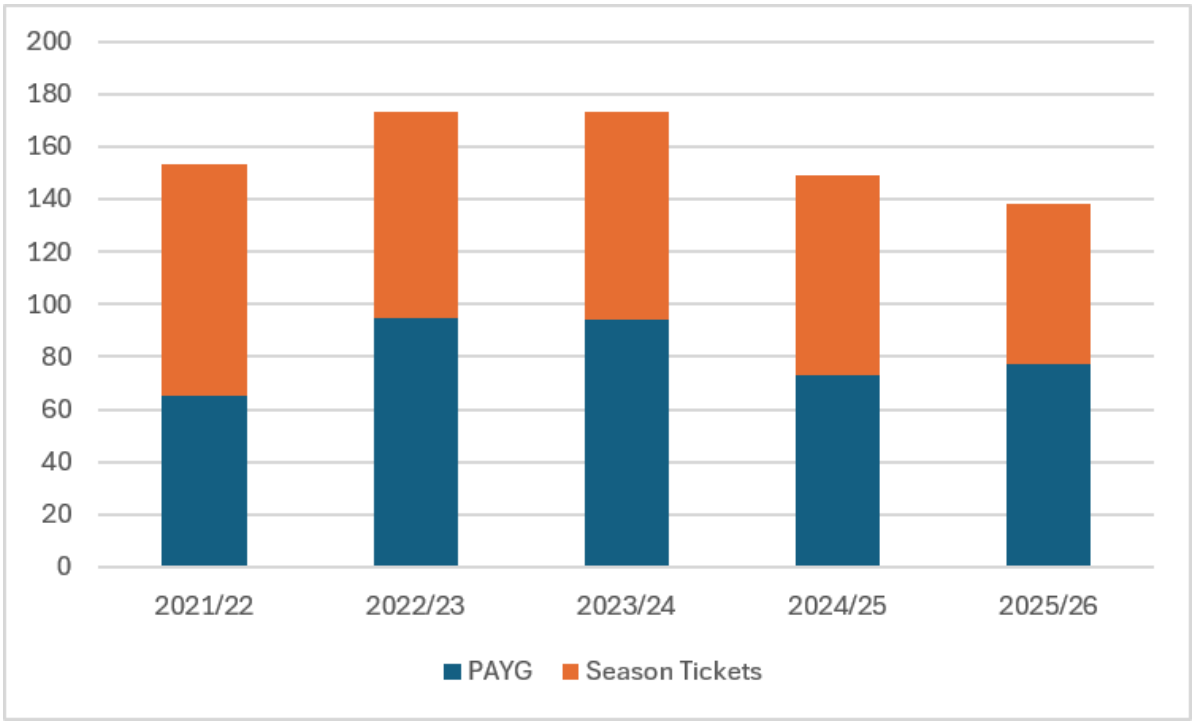
Membership

SFS membership in the 2025/26 season fell back a little from the previous year. The total number of members this year was 138, this compares to an average of 149 for last year.

The drop was entirely due to a reduction in Season Ticket membership, which went down from 76 to 61 members. On the other hand we had slightly more PAYG members join and guest membership remained strong, averaging 6 per film.

24 members joined the Society for the first time in 2025/26, which was comparable with previous years.

Membership numbers over the last 5 years:



Film Audiences and Reactions

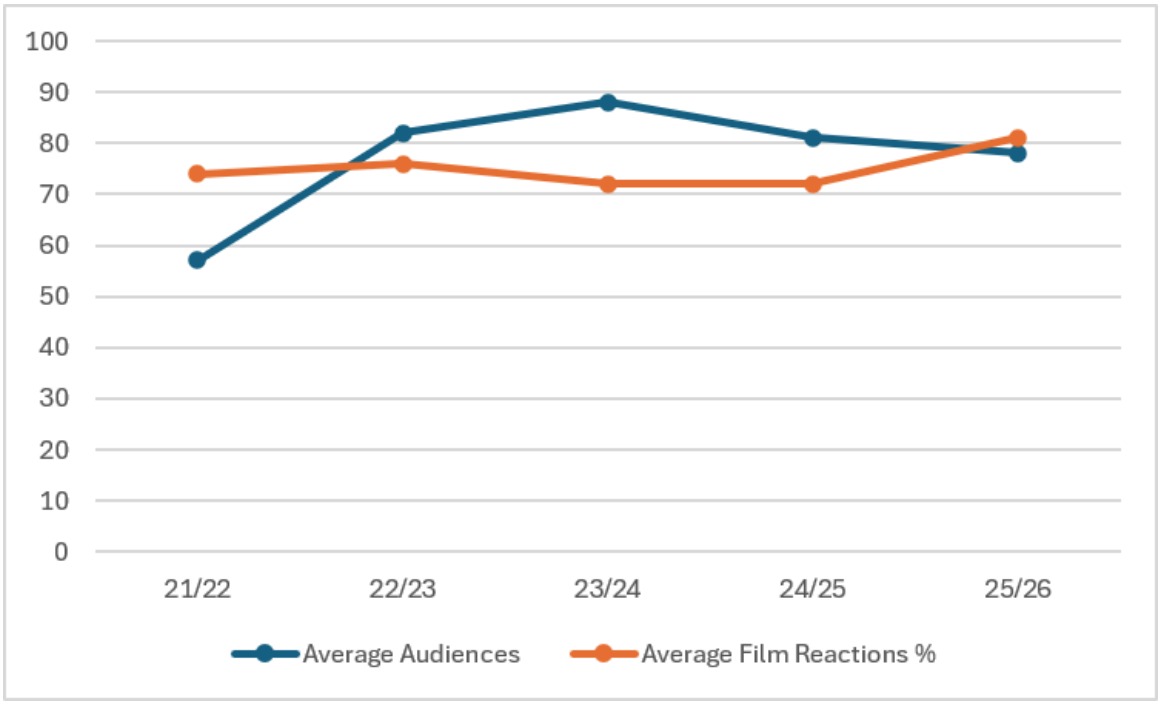
Audience numbers have dropped very slightly this year. This year's average attendance was 78.

The best attended film was the Italian war-time drama, *Vermiglio*: 101 people came to this film. The lowest attendance was for *September 5* which had an audience of just 59.

Our films were generally very popular. The average audience reaction was 81% which was significantly higher than the previous four years. The top film was the Political Thriller *I'm Still Here* with 92%, whilst the lowest rated film was *Misericordia* scoring 66%.

2025/26 FILMS	ATTENDANCE	REACTION %
My Favourite Cake	83	83
Driving Mum	77	78
Vermiglio	101	79
If Only I Could Hibernate	67	81
Holy Cow	98	81
La Chimera	65	73
Memoir of a Snail	78	85
A Real Pain	85	85
All We Imagine As Light	84	73
I'm Still Here	79	92
Crossing	56	79
Touch	92	88
Misericordia	67	66
September 5	59	86
Average	78	81

Audience numbers and scores over the last 5 years:



In May we showed *The Ballad of Wallis Island* extra to our programme. This was possible because the Arts Centre allowed us to have the theatre for free to compensate for no heating at a number of films over the winter. This film was attended by 50 people and scored 91%.

Marketing and Advertising

For 2025-26 we continued to produce our standard material for the season: the SFS brochure, posters, synopsis sheets, membership cards and reaction slips. Our designer, Rachel Martin, was excellent as always and she continued to support us with the design of all this material. Rachel's creative touch is always much appreciated.

Where possible we have sought to get articles into the local print media and on local radio – thanks to Rosemary for her recent radio appearance. Sue has taken the lead on marketing and she has been a great asset.

Special thanks go to Richard Turpin, our Webmaster who has kept our fantastic website updated throughout the season.

Thank you for your continued support and enjoy all the films!

Swindon Film – November 2026

A member of Cinema for All / British Federation of Film Societies
swindonfilm.org.uk